

The dashed lines in Figure 5-4 first show a *contracting triangle* (reflecting the form of wave (IV) in Figure 3-1). A contracting or ascending (i.e., one with a horizontal top) triangle would fulfill the greatest number of Elliott Wave guidelines. In such a pattern, the Dow would stage its deepest drop early, which is the best way to achieve the downside target zone and have prices remain within the Millennium degree channel. Because of the long duration of Supercycle wave (V), the lower parallel line of the Millennium wave is on a path that will make the target zone otherwise unattainable several decades hence. A substantial decline for wave (A) of the triangle would nicely fit the outlook for wave C down that is due in the inflation-adjusted Dow.

The second diagram shows an *expanding triangle* (reflecting the form of wave IV in Figure 2-5). The third diagram shows an *expanded flat* (reflecting the form of wave ④ of III in Figure 2-5). The fourth shows a *double three* (with a triangle in the position of the second three, reflecting the form of the 1966-1982 pattern, as shown in Figure 2-7).

As explained earlier, when a market has several levels of structural support, sometimes corrections oblige by producing reversals in subwaves at more than one of those levels. All of the patterns postulated in Figure 5-4 allow the market to meet more than one of the support levels discussed under **Extent**, at the lows of waves (A) and (C), and/or (E).

Despite the fair probability that the downside target will be met early in the pattern, there is no way to be certain of it. When dealing with Intermediate and Primary trends, the lowest point is ultimately achieved within weeks or months, so there is little practical difference in whether the price low occurs early or late in the pattern. However, the scale of the upcoming bear market will be many times larger. If the Dow is still well above its ultimate downside target a decade from now, do not assume that it will not be met. One could have made a similar erroneous assumption in 1968 or 1973 about a correction of Cycle degree.

Even though the look of the pattern will be "sideways," the size of the Grand Supercycle correction has extremely important practical implications. The price swings are likely to be so dramatic as to provide phenomenal investment returns to a successful long term market timer, while battering the so-called and recently rediscovered long term investor and his successors out of the game.